Project Synopsis

HostelConnect -
Smart Hostel Life Platform

Submitted By:

Komalpreet Grewal - 12303600

Kusukuntala Vyshnavi - 12303433

Nandana S - 12317635

Urshita Parmar – 12303424

K23DV

B. Tech CSE – DevOps (Software Development and IT Operations)

Submitted To:

Utkarsh Agarwal

1. Introduction

HostelConnect is a centralized digital platform designed to improve communication, collaboration, and daily life management for hostel residents.

In most hostels, students face issues like:

- Lack of proper communication channels
- No structured complaint system
- Unorganized mess information
- No anonymous expression platform

HostelConnect addresses these problems by integrating key features like real-time chat, mess menu display, anonymous posting, and a structured complaint management system into a single platform. This creates a more connected, transparent, and efficient hostel environment.

2. Objective

The main objective of HostelConnect is to develop an integrated platform that enhances communication, transparency, and overall management within hostel environments. The system focuses on solving common challenges faced by students by providing the following key objectives:

- **Real-time communication:** To enable seamless interaction among same hostel residents/same compound hostel residents through group chats, room chats, and direct messaging.
- **Mess menu access:** To provide students with easy and organized access to daily meal information.
- **Anonymous posting:** To allow students to freely share opinions, feedback, and queries without revealing their identity.
- **Complaint management:** To implement a structured system for reporting issues, tracking their status, and ensuring accountability.

- **Community building:** To create a connected and interactive hostel ecosystem that encourages student engagement.

By achieving these objectives, HostelConnect aims to improve efficiency, reduce communication gaps, and create a more transparent and user-friendly hostel experience.

3. Scope of the Project

The scope of HostelConnect covers multiple user groups and aims to improve various aspects of hostel management and student interaction.

Users of the System:

- Hostel students
- Mess representatives
- Hostel administrators

Scope and Functional Coverage:

The platform is designed to:

- **Improve communication:** Enable real-time interaction through chat systems, reducing dependency on informal channels.
- **Increase transparency:** Provide clear visibility into complaints, their status, and resolution process.
- **Reduce manual effort:** Digitize complaint handling and mess updates, minimizing paperwork and manual coordination.
- **Enhance student engagement:** Encourage participation through chats, anonymous posts, and feedback systems.
- **Centralize information:** Offer a single platform for mess menus, announcements, complaints, and communication.
- **Enable quick issue resolution:** Allow faster reporting and tracking of hostel-related problems.
- **Support decision-making:** Help administrators analyze common issues and improve hostel services.

- **Ensure accessibility:** Provide easy access to information anytime and from any device.
- **Promote community building:** Strengthen connections among residents through interactive features.
- **Scalable design:** Allow future expansion such as adding new modules like events, polls, or notifications.

The project scope focuses on creating a comprehensive, efficient, and user-friendly system that improves both management and student experience within hostels.

4. System Modules

1) Chat System

- Real-time messaging using WebSockets
- Types:
  - Hostel group chat
  - Room-based chat
  - Direct messaging

Additional Features:

- Online/offline user status
- Message timestamps
- Basic notifications for new messages

Enables instant and continuous communication among students.

2) Mess Food System

- Displays daily menu:
  - Breakfast
  - Lunch
  - Tea/Snacks

    - Dinner
- Admin updates menu

Additional Features:

- Date-wise menu viewing
- Meal rating system
- Feedback/comments on meals
- Option to highlight special meals

3) Anonymous Post System

- Users can post without revealing identity

Features:

- Confessions
- Questions
- Upvotes
- Comments

Additional Features:

- Time/date of posts
- Sorting posts (latest / most popular)
- Basic content moderation (admin control)

4) Complaint Logging System

- Users can report issues:
    - Infrastructure problems
    - Maintenance issues

Features:

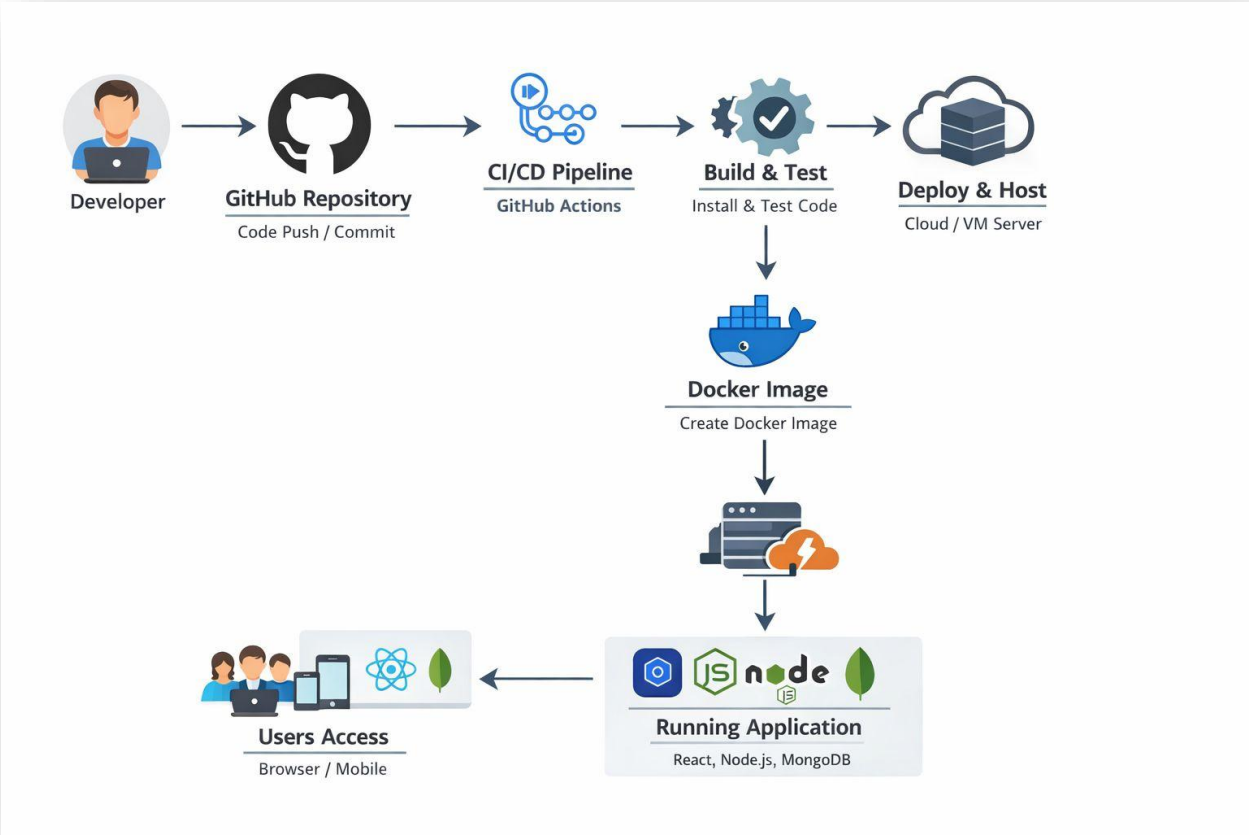
- Status tracking:
    - Pending
    - In Progress
    - Resolved

- Upvote similar complaints

Additional Features:

- Complaint category (electrical, water, etc.)
- Admin remarks/updates
- Notification on status change
- Priority-based handling with AI

5. Workflow Diagram



6. Workflow of the System

Step-by-Step Workflow

1. User registers/logs in
2. User accesses dashboard
3. Based on action:

- **Chat Flow**
  - User sends message → Socket server → Delivered instantly
- **Mess Menu Flow**
  - Admin updates menu → Stored in DB → Displayed to users
- **Post Flow**
  - User creates anonymous post → Stored → Visible in feed → Users interact
- **Complaint Flow**
  - User submits complaint → Stored → Others upvote → Admin updates status

7. Database Design (Basic Collections)

Section	Field 1	Field 2	Field 3	Field 4	Field 5
Users	id	name	hostel	room	
Messages	sender	receiver	message	timestamp	
Posts	content	anonymous	votes	comments	
Complaints	title	description	location	status	votes
Mess Menu	date	breakfast	lunch	tea/snacks	dinner

8. Technologies Used

Frontend

- React.js
- HTML, CSS, JavaScript

Backend

- Node.js
- Express.js

Database

- MongoDB

Real-Time

- Socket.io

DevOps

- Docker
- GitHub Actions (CI/CD)
- Deployment on cloud/server

9. Advantages

- Centralized system
- Real-time communication
- Transparent complaint tracking
- Encourages student interaction
- Scalable architecture

10. Conclusion

HostelConnect is a practical and scalable platform that enhances hostel life by integrating communication, mess management, anonymous interaction, and complaint handling into a single system. It improves efficiency, transparency, and student engagement while demonstrating real-world full-stack development and DevOps practices.